

M. Cecilia Ramírez Michelena

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

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Professional Summary

Economist and Ph.D. candidate with six years of experience in applied microeconomics, randomized evaluations, and policy-oriented research, including direct engagement with Spanish public institutions on social policy. Experience includes field implementation of randomized evaluations with vulnerable populations in Uruguay, a research–practice partnership with public institutions in the United States, and the design of a funded school-based RCT in Catalonia developed in coordination with the Generalitat de Catalunya. Trained in causal inference, experimental design, and applied microeconometrics, with experience producing quantitative evidence and translating research findings into policy outputs for non-academic audiences.

Core Competencies: Impact evaluation; randomized evaluations; evidence synthesis and dissemination; research–practice and government partnerships; RCT feasibility and implementation; applied microeconometrics; literature reviews; policy briefs and evaluation summaries; training and capacity building; stakeholder presentations.

Professional Experience

Institut d’Economia de Barcelona, Universitat de Barcelona

01/2023 – Present

Predoctoral Researcher and Instructor

Barcelona, Spain

- Conduct applied research in education and labor economics using administrative microdata and causal inference methods to study educational trajectories, gender inequality, and labor-market outcomes in Spain. Working papers presented at EALE, SEHO, KU Leuven, and Barcelona School of Economics.
- Design and prepare the implementation of a school-based randomized information intervention in secondary schools in Catalonia, funded by the *Women and Science* Program at Paris Dauphine–PSL, aimed at reducing the gender gap in STEM. Lead day-to-day project development, including treatment design, survey design and implementation planning, school engagement, budget management, research assistant supervision, and coordination with schools and education stakeholders.

Education Policy Analytics Lab, College of Education, University of Washington

09/2018 – 09/2019

Predoctoral Researcher

Seattle, United States

- Worked in a research–practice partnership with Seattle Public Schools — the largest K–12 provider in Washington State — analyzing administrative data on teacher effectiveness, absenteeism, recruitment, and retention in high-poverty schools.
- Shaped empirical questions through ongoing dialogue with district executives, school administrators, union representatives, and program managers, keeping the analysis connected to operational priorities.
- Produced internal reports, technical notes, and presentations to communicate findings to senior district leadership and support evidence-informed planning.

Center for Research in Applied Economics, Universidad de Montevideo

06/2015 – 07/2018

Research Assistant and Field Leader

Montevideo, Uruguay

- Managed field implementation workstreams for randomized evaluations with vulnerable populations in Uruguay, including a social benefits take-up and labor inclusion intervention with more than 300 informal street workers and a digital inclusion intervention with over 120 institutionalized older adults in a public hospital.
- Designed and revised survey instruments and field protocols, supervised data collection, cleaned and validated survey data, conducted quantitative analysis, and prepared reports, research outputs, and practitioner-facing materials.
- Coordinated day-to-day field activities with ministries, municipal departments, hospitals, frontline providers, social workers, research assistants, and implementing partners, ensuring field procedures, data quality, and implementation constraints remained aligned with the evaluation design.

Education

Universitat de Barcelona, Barcelona, Spain

Ph.D. in Economics

Expected 09/2026

Dissertation: *Essays on gender inequality, educational choices, and labor-market pathways.*

Supervisors: Profs. Lúdia Farré and Andreu Arenas.

Visiting Doctoral Student, Columbia University , New York, United States	Fall 2026
Visiting Doctoral Student, Paris School of Economics , Paris, France	June 2026
University of Washington , Seattle, United States	
M.Ed. in Educational Foundations, Leadership, and Policy Studies	2021
Specialization in <i>Organizational and Policy Studies</i>	
M.A. in Economics	2021
Universidad de Montevideo , Montevideo, Uruguay	
M.A. in Economics	2020
B.A. in Economics	2016
B.A. in Management and Business Administration	2016

Grants & Fellowships

Fellowships

Dr. Joan Guinovart Fellowship, Societat Econòmica Barcelonesa d'Amics del País (2026).
 Doctoral Fellowship, Fundación Ramón Areces (2023–2026).
 Doctoral Fellowship, Generalitat de Catalunya (2023).
 Graduate Fellowship, University of Washington (2018–2020).
 Fulbright Scholarship for Graduate Studies, Fulbright Commission (2018–2020).
 Research Scholarship, Universidad de Montevideo (2016–2018).

Research Grants

Women and Science Program, Paris Dauphine-PSL University – PI: Prof. Lúdia Farré. EUR 10,000 (2024).

Teaching Experience & Student Supervision

Universitat de Barcelona – Instructor and B.A. Thesis Advisor, Department of Economics	Spring 2024 – Present
University of Washington – Instructor, Department of Spanish and Portuguese Studies	Fall 2020 – Spring 2021
Universidad de Montevideo – Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics	Fall 2014 – Spring 2015

Technical Skills & Languages

Methods	Randomized evaluations; causal inference; difference-in-differences; event-study designs; discrete choice experiments; power calculations; survey design; evidence synthesis.
Tools/Data	Stata; R; Python; Microsoft Office; LaTeX; Git/GitHub; administrative, survey, education, labor-market, social security, and randomized evaluation data.
Outputs	Policy briefs; evaluation summaries; literature reviews; analytical reports; implementation memos; training materials; stakeholder presentations.
Languages	Spanish native; English fluent; Catalan intermediate.

Selected Research

- Abilities and Career Choices: Addressing the Gender Gap in STEM Fields. With A. Arenas and L. Farré. Working Paper. Presented at BRIDGE Economics of Education Workshop (KU Leuven) and SEHO Annual Meeting, 2025.
- Educational Gains from School Electrification in Rural Areas. With M. Blanco and N. D'Agosti. Working Paper. Presented at European Association of Labour Economists (EALE) and BSE, 2024.
- The Evolution of the Child Penalty and the Gender Wage Gap in Spain. With A. Arenas and L. Farré. Working Paper.
- Strategies to Increase the Take-up of Social Benefits: Evidence from a Field Experiment. With A. Cid, J.M. Cabrera, and M. Blanco. Working Paper.
- Tablets for Deeply Disadvantaged Older Adults: Challenges in Long-term Care Facilities. With A. Cid, R. Sotelo, and M. Leguisamo. *International Journal of Human-Computer Studies* (2020).